

Bahrain



Tree of Life

Against all odds, a single tree—aptly named the Tree of Life—has flourished in Bahrain's southern desert for four centuries, in a barren area 25 miles (40 km) south of Manama.



- 📏 293 sq miles (760 sq km)
- 👤 1.5 million
- ★ Manama
- 🗨 Arabic

Bahrain is a tiny island nation in the Gulf of Qatar, made up of more than **30 natural and artificial islands**. It is mostly **flat, low-lying** desert. The country's **economy** depends on its **vast oil and gas reserves**, as well as on **banking and tourism**.



Bahraini pearls

Bahrain is known for its high-quality natural pearls, collected from oysters on the sea bed of the Persian Gulf. The harvested pearls are checked for quality and size before being sold.



Kuwait Towers

These landmark towers have stood by the shore of Kuwait City since 1979. They are just some of the 34 water towers dotted around the city.

The *Arabian Desert* makes up most of the country's landscape.



0 20 km
0 20 miles
(approximate scale)

The lower half of this sphere is a water reservoir, while the upper half houses a restaurant.

Kuwait



Crab hunters

Thousands of crab plovers inhabit Kuwait's coastline where they wade in shallow waters hunting crabs.



- 📏 6,880 sq miles (17,818 sq km)
- 👤 3 million
- ★ Kuwait City
- 🗨 Arabic, English

Despite being a small country, **oil-rich** Kuwait is one of the **richest** in the world. Most of its population lives in **Kuwait City**, a **sprawling capital** of **modern skyscrapers**. **Camel racing** is a **popular pastime**.